

Objection Map Template

Day 4 · Activity 2 handout. For each predicted objection from your stakeholder, capture the honest response, the pivot, and the smallest ground you'd give. This is the spine of SEP §4 meeting prep.

How to build it

1. Predict the stakeholder's **top 5 objections**, ranked by intensity. Voice them honestly — not strawmen. At least one should be **hostile** (the one they'd push hardest).
2. For each, write an **honest response** (what's actually true — do not over-promise), a **pivot** (where to redirect if pushback continues), and **the line you hold** (the smallest ground you'd give if the objection wins).
3. Flag the **highest-stakes objection** — the one most likely to derail the meeting — and rehearse it aloud.

Per-objection template

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### Objection N: <short name>
**The stakeholder says:** <quoted, in their voice>

**The honest response:** <what's actually true; do not over-promise>

**The pivot (if pushback continues):** <where to redirect — usually
to a deeper "why" or to a documented trade-off>

**The line we hold:** <if this objection wins, what's the smallest
ground we give up?>
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Worked example — Compliance, async audit write

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### Objection 3: Regulator can't see events in real time
**The stakeholder says:** "If an auditor pulls the log mid-incident,
they'll see stale state. That's on me to explain."

**The honest response:** Events are durable at action-time (Kafka + DLQ);
the store lags 1–10s, not the record itself. Nothing is lost — only
delayed in the read model.

**The pivot (if pushback continues):** We can bound the lag with an SLO
(≤ 10s p99) and alert on breach, so you have a defensible number to cite.

**The line we hold:** We hold durability and the ≤10s p99 bound. We would
NOT commit to synchronous < 1s write unless a contract requires it — that
breaks the dispatcher p95 SLO.
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The bar for "good"

- Objections sound **like the stakeholder would actually say them**, not strawmen.
 - "The honest response" states what's **true**, not just what persuades.
 - "The line we hold" is **specific** — not "we'll compromise."
 - The highest-stakes objection has a **rehearsed** response by the end.
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Non-negotiables (pairs with the objection map)

The 1–3 things you cannot give up. Knowing these before the meeting is the defense against folding under pressure.

- Each non-negotiable is **specific** — not "quality" or "the user."
- Each has a **fallback** — the scope / time / approach you'd give up to protect it.
- The list is **short**: 3 maximum. (Teams with 6+ non-negotiables fold, because they can't defend them all.)

NON-NEGOTIABLE	FALLBACK (WHAT WE'D CUT TO PROTECT IT)
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Examples: "We will not compromise the audit-trail retention requirement." · "We will not slip launch past July 1 — we'll cut scope first." · "We will not break the SSO scope contract with Identity."